another battalion commander, was breathing down my neck and wanted to know my decision. I decided to go in for a raid on the camp with the force that was available with me. When we assaulted the camp, the insurgents (a company of 7 Guards) were taken unawares. The company commander of the insurgents was literally caught with his pants down! We took him into custody in his white kurta pyjama and when he requested me to allow him to change into uniform I refused. This was the best proof of the degree of surprise we had achieved. Our performance came in for a lot of praise during the summing up, and the exercise was terminated.



A pep talk to motivate the officers, JCOs and men before an operation.

Thereafter, we were asked to keep ourselves prepared for the real task. To ensure a high standard of fitness we used to run 8–10 kilometres everyday. I was barely thirty-five years old and in good shape and took pride in running with the soldiers.

Sometime in November 1981 we were given orders to destroy a major camp of the insurgents on the Indo-Myanmar border. In order to spring a surprise, we made a non-stop move from Tezu for a